

Goran Trajkovski, Ph.D.

First AI paper: 1995. Last exit: 2025. Everything in between: building things that teach people.

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PROFILE

I started publishing AI research in 1995, back when you had to explain what a neural network was. Since then: ran an NSF-funded robotics lab, built online programs for universities that had never done online, managed curriculum for 130,000 students at WGU (promoted 7 times in 10 years), and sold my edtech startup to Pluralsight in 2025. Along the way I wrote 20+ books, chaired 72 thesis committees, worked on NASA projects, and somehow ended up a Fulbright Scholar. I've also run my own consulting practice for 25 years. I build things. Usually they work.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CEO

enlAIten AI | Remote | 2024–Oct 2025

Built an assessment quality assurance platform. Pluralsight acquired us in 18 months.

- The product: 7 different similarity algorithms (BERT, TF-IDF, LSA, Word2Vec, etc.) to detect overlap in question banks—critical for test security. Plus AI-powered item review that could simulate SME panels and check Bloom's alignment.
- Landed partnerships with educational institutions before we had a sales team. Product demonstrated its own value.

CEO

The Art of Living Large | Baltimore, MD | Jan 2000–Present

My consulting practice. 25 years of e-learning solutions for organizations launching online education operations.

- Specialize in high-risk, cutting-edge projects—the ones that implement emerging tech in educational products

Director, Data Analytics & AI Council Founding Member

Touro University Illinois | Remote | Jul 2023–Aug 2025

They brought me in to figure out AI governance for a 19,000-student global system. Also built new programs.

- Built the MS in Data Analytics for Healthcare and an Executive Master's in AI Strategy—\$3M portfolio, 98% regulatory approval
- International enrollment up 45% (Israel, Germany, Russia). After Hurricane Maria, helped rebuild Puerto Rico technical education—15,000 displaced students.

Lead Academic Program Manager (and 6 prior roles)

Western Governors University | Salt Lake City, UT | Oct 2014–Dec 2024

Ten years. Seven roles. Started as Course Lead, ended as Lead Academic Program Manager. 130,000+ students.

Progression: Course Lead → Senior Course Lead → Supervisor → Manager → Senior Manager, Compliance → Senior Lead Advisor → Lead APM

- Ran a \$2M annual budget and 125-person team. Course completion up 25%, support tickets down 40%.
- Students graduated 6 months faster. Satisfaction: 4.7/5. Every accreditation we went for, we got—15+ programs, 100% approval.

Lead Learning Experience Producer – Technology

Visa, Inc. | San Francisco, CA | Jan 2021–Dec 2022

Visa needed a Data Science curriculum for their tech workforce. I built it. \$2M budget. NPS over 90%.

Executive Director, Adult and Graduate Studies

Marian University | Fond du Lac, WI | Jun 2013–Sep 2014

- Ran continuing education as a standalone business. Expanded offerings 37% across Wisconsin. Led HLC reaffirmation.

CTO & Dean, School of Engineering

World Education University | Palm Springs, CA | Nov 2011–Jul 2013

- Startup university. Built proprietary LMS from scratch, devised MOOC process, established School of Engineering.

Dean, School of CIS & Online Education; Professor

Virginia International University | Fairfax, VA | Apr 2010–Jul 2013

- Built VIU's first online programs. 10 new graduate programs. Academic partnerships: Mongolia, Indonesia, Ghana, Brazil, Saudi Arabia.

Director, Product Strategy and Development

Laureate Education Inc. | Baltimore, MD | Apr 2008–Apr 2010

- Product strategy for Laureate's IT/Engineering vertical. 40+ institutions, 500,000 students. Built ACE (Academic Computing Environment).

Chair, IT Programs & Associate Professor

South University | Savannah, GA | May 2007–Jun 2008

- Grew department from 100 to 3,000 students across five campuses. Prepared for programmatic accreditation—approved.

Assistant Professor & Director, Cognitive Agency and Robotics Lab

Towson University | Towson, MD | Aug 2002–Aug 2007

- Built NSF-funded research lab. Chaired 15 Ph.D. dissertations and 57 master's theses. NSF REU: 15 summer interns.

Assistant Professor of Computer Science

West Virginia University, Parkersburg | Parkersburg, WV | Aug 1999–Aug 2002

- Developed new CS and Business courses. Delivered residential and hybrid instruction.

Research Assistant

NASA IV&V / West Virginia University | Fairmont, WV | Aug 1998–Aug 1999

- Contributed to NASA-funded projects on reliability of embedded control systems in aircraft

Instructor

SS Cyril and Methodius University | Skopje, Macedonia | Oct 1995–Aug 1998

- Taught calculus (I–V) and Computational Approaches to Engineering to EE, CS, and Telecom undergrads

OTHER ROLES (CONCURRENT)

Content & Assessment

- Pluralsight (2024–now): AI courses, Skill IQ assessments, practice exams (Google Cloud, CISSP, AWS, Azure, CompTIA, etc.)
- Coursera (2024–now): Financial analytics courses | UC Berkeley Extension (2025): Biostatistics—10 modules, 135 hrs
- Hurix Digital (2024–now): Assessment development for WGU | WGU AI SuperSME (2025–now): AI in nursing programs
- ansrSource (2018–now): Data Science programs for Fortune 500 | Febr.is (2021–2024): Co-founded XR education platform

Teaching

- SNHU (2022–now): CS—AI applications, software dev | UMGC (2022–now): Data Analytics, AI Ethics
- Colorado Technical (2018–now): Business Analytics | Grand Canyon (2017–now): Data Mining, ML | Rasmussen (2014–now): Data Science

Editorial

- Editor-in-Chief, International Journal of Agent Technology and Systems, IGI Global (2008–2017, 9+ years)

ACCREDITATION WORK

Inside Organizations

- WGU: 15+ programs, 100% approval | South: 5 campuses | Touro: \$3M portfolio, 98% | VIU: SACS and ACICS prep
- Built IRB infrastructure at multiple institutions

Agency Service

- ACCSC: Site evaluator | ACE: Credit recommendation | MSCHE: Review team | ABET: Program evaluator

Current Consulting

- ADGroup Puerto Rico (2025–now): ADTEC, CEM College, Caribbean Forensic & Technical, PPG Technical, ICPR Junior College

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & PUBLICATIONS

Portfolio of 300+ publications including 20+ books. First AI publication (1995) establishing 30-year research heritage.

Books and Edited Volumes

Trajkovski (2026). *Adversarial AI threat response and secure model design* [under contract]. Apress/Springer.

Trajkovski & Hayes (2025). *AI-assisted assessment in education: Transforming assessment and measuring learning*. Palgrave Macmillan. DOI

Trajkovski (2025). *Mind meets machine: The evolution of learning from ancient wisdom to AI*. ISBN 979-8266284319.

Trajkovski (2025). *Principles of healthcare data analytics: A conceptual and practical approach*. Cognella.

Trajkovski (2024). *Nurturing Bloom's garden: How AI transforms the educational landscape*. Amazon

Trajkovski (2024). *Prompt Engineering for Instructors: Revolutionizing Education with AI*. Cognella Academic Publishing.

Trajkovski (2024). *AI unleashed: A college student's guide to navigating and mastering generative AI*. Amazon

Trajkovski (2023). *A more beautiful prompt: The art of human-centered prompt engineering*. beautifulprompt.expert

Braun & Trajkovski (2023). *Designing context-rich learning by extending reality*. IGI Global. DOI

Hossain, Ho & Trajkovski (2023). *Handbook of research on AI and ML applications in customer support and analytics*. IGI. DOI

Trajkovski, Demeter & Hayes (2022). *Applying data science and learning analytics throughout a learner's lifespan*. IGI. DOI

Trajkovski (2011). *Developments in intelligent agent technologies and multi-agent systems*. IGI. [Link](#)
Trajkovski & Collins (2009). *Handbook of research on agent-based societies: Social and cultural interactions*. IGI. [Link](#)
Trajkovski (2006). *Diversity in information technology education: Issues and controversies*. IGI. [DOI](#)

Book Chapters and Journal Articles

Empowering research through strategic administration (2025). In *IRB, human research protections, and data ethics*, IGI. [DOI](#)
Bridging the public administration-AI divide: A skills perspective (2024). *Public Administration and Development*. [DOI](#)
Contemporary issues and framings in crowdsourced education dialogue (2024). In *Reshaping learning with next generation educational technologies*. IGI. [DOI](#)
Defining the context-rich learning framework (2023). In Braun & Trajkovski (Eds.), *Designing context-rich learning*. IGI. [Link](#)
It's all about context: Differential item functioning in IT performance assessments (2023). IGI. [DOI](#)
Don't @ Me: A study of perception of Twitter users of educational offerings (2022). IGI. [DOI](#)
Identifying structure in program-level competencies and skills (2022). IGI. [DOI](#)
Bridging the gaps between higher education, industry, and the learner: Skills-first approach (2022). IGI. [DOI](#)
Transparency of cognitive complexity in performance assessments: A validity study (2021). *Journal of Competency-Based Education*. [DOI](#)
Future trends in global online learning (2018). In *Resources for international psychology*. Global Scholarly Publications.

Conference Presentations

The agent and the assistant: Cultivating AI literacy (2025). AI4 Conference, Las Vegas. [ai4.io](#)
Build-a-Future: Redefining academic writing and admissions in the AI era (2025). RNL National Conference, Atlanta.
Embracing the future: AI as a catalyst for connectivism learning ecosystems (2025). RNL National Conference, Atlanta.
Where is your L&D team on the AI adoption curve? (2024). Training Industry. [Link](#)
The compliance compass: Navigating AI research regulations (2024). Cayuse Connect. [Link](#)
AI and consent: Redefining participant empowerment (2024). Cayuse Connect.
AI-enhanced pedagogy: Guiding emerging technologies in higher education (2024). GCU Keynote. [Link](#)
CTRL+ALT_TRANSFORM: Your role in the AI era (2024). Cengage. [Link](#)
HEART: Charting a humane AI course for HR professionals (2024). HR Professionals Magazine/SHRM.
Tech and (A)I: Upskill and move up (2024). CHIEF.
Empathy and algorithms: Balancing human dignity and data in research (2023). Cayuse.
Datafication and its discontents: Navigating human subject research (2023). Cayuse.
Identifying biases in performance assessments: Differential item functioning approach (2022). Assessment Institute, IUPUI.
A recipe for meaningful assessment in online competency-based higher education (2019). Assessment Institute, IUPUI.
A way forward: Mitigating gaps in performance assessments (2018). Drexel University.

Executive Education & Online Courses

Pluralsight (2025): Perplexity Advanced Features [in prep] | Design Reliable Streaming Architectures [in prep]
Pluralsight (2025): Adversarial AI series — [Introduction](#) | [Ethics & Impact](#) | [Detection & Defense](#)
Pluralsight (2025): [Experimental Design and Causal Inference in R](#) | [Practical Applications of Claude](#)
Pluralsight Skill IQ assessments: AI Ops, Cryptography, LLM, Machine Learning Engineering, Quality Engineering, Confluence, dbt, NestJS, Agile, and ~10 more
Pluralsight Practice Exams: Google Cloud, CompTIA Linux+, CISSP, AWS Security, Azure Networking, Cloud Architect, CCNA, Spring Professional, AWS Advanced Networking, CompTIA A+, SSCP, CCNP Data Center, Microsoft 365
Coursera (2025): Financial analytics series — Interpret Alpha & Beta with Regression, Transform Financial Data, Regression Assumptions & Models

Other Publications

Indispensable strategists: The past, present, and bright future of research administration (2024). Cayuse. [Link](#)
Building back better: How technical schools drive Puerto Rico's recovery (2025). The evoLLLution. [Link](#)
AI's true face in higher education: 10 myths shattered (2024). The evoLLLution. [Link](#)
When ancient wisdom meets byte-sized brilliance (2024). Cengage Blog. [Link](#)
The future is now: How prompt engineering unlocks AI's potential for higher education (2024). evoLLLution. [Link](#)
Charting a humane AI course for HR (2023). HR Professionals Magazine. [Link](#)
Navigating technological waves in the evolving HR workplace (2023). HR Professionals Magazine. [Link](#)
Ctrl+Alt+Innovate: The radical shift of designers in the AI-driven classroom (2023). evoLLLution. [Link](#)
7 steps to identify and address bias in educational assessments (2023). evoLLLution. [Link](#)
Packaging the educational product for the digital economy (2022). evoLLLution. [Link](#)

CURRICULAR DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT HIGHLIGHTS

- Pluralsight (2025): Course authoring and assessment development—Adversarial AI series, Claude, Experimental Design in R, Perplexity, Streaming Architectures. Skill IQ assessments and practice exams across 25+ technology domains.
- Coursera (2025): Financial analytics series—Interpret Alpha & Beta with Regression, Transform Financial Data, Regression Assumptions & Models.

- UC Berkeley Extension (2025): SME and course designer for MCELLBI X471 Biostatistics—10 modules, 135 contact hours, R programming and modern biostatistical applications.
- Touro University: New stackable credentials, Executive Masters in AI Strategy and Leadership, MS in Data Analytics for Healthcare.
- Western Governors University: New programs design and development, assessment design—MS and BS in Data Analytics, Cybersecurity, IT Management; MS and MBA in Data Analytics, Business Analytics, IT Management, Healthcare Management, Cloud Computing, Data Management.
- Grand Canyon University: Course authoring (MS Data Science, MS Computer Science programs).
- Forbes Inc.: Bootcamp authoring (Data Science Bootcamp).
- Arizona State University: Program design, course authoring (Data Science and Analytics certificate program).
- United States University: New MBA specializations (MBA/MIS, MS in MIS, IT, and CS).
- Virginia International University: 10 programs—MS Information Technology, MS Software Engineering, MS Information Systems Management, Graduate Certificates (Business Intelligence, IT Audit & Compliance, IS Management, Information Systems), MS Computer Science, MS Information Systems, BS Computer Science.
- Walden University: MS in Information System Management—market research through delivery platform, podcasts, alternative channels, student collaboration infrastructure.
- University of Liverpool Online: MS in IT version for career changers without IT background.
- Universidad Europea de Madrid (Spain): MOGITI program migration online—infrastructure, instructional design, sync/async delivery.
- Business and Information Technology School (Germany): IT programs revision and online migration process.
- South University: MS in Information Systems and Technology—market research through delivery, on-ground and online versions.
- Towson University: Doctoral program in IT (DIT), BS Molecular Biology/Biochemistry/Bioinformatics—Bioinformatics track.

GRANTS & PATENT

- National Academies of Sciences (PI): Federal contract—Evolving concepts in humans inhabiting simple virtual environments
- Fulbright-Hays (Participant): Short-term studies in Bulgaria
- OWASP Spring of Code (PI): The Scholastic Application Security Assessment Project

Patent: Vaughn & Trajkovski (2025). Statistical output distribution modulation. US App. US20250077185A1. [Google Patents](#)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Computer Science — SS Cyril and Methodius University

Ph.D., Computer Engineering (ABD) — West Virginia University

MBA, Healthcare Management — Western Governors University

M.S., Management and Leadership — Western Governors University

M.S., Applied and Computational Mathematics — SS Cyril and Methodius University

B.E., Applied Computer Science — SS Cyril and Methodius University

Certifications: Google Project Management Professional | Product Strategy & AI Micro-credentials (Product School)

RECOGNITION

- Fulbright Scholar | NSF Grant Recipient | Senior Member, IEEE | Member, American Society for Public Administration
- NASA Postdoctoral Program Reviewer | CODiE Awards Judge (2020–present) | Featured Reviewer, ACM Computing Reviews
- WGU: Rookie of the Year, Innovation Award, Academic Authenticity Partner Award, Student Obsession Award, Influencer Award
- Founding Editor-in-Charge, International Journal of Agent Technologies and Systems, IGI Global
- Program Committee Member, AAAI symposia | Organizing Committee, AAAI Spring Symposium on Creativity and Cognitive Development